

DECORY EDWARDS

Baltimore, MD
(832) 472-6440
dedwar65@jhu.edu
github.com/dedwar65



EDUCATION

Johns Hopkins University

Ph.D. in Economics (Expected May 2026)

Baltimore, MD

Trinity University

B.A. in Economics · B.A. in Mathematics

San Antonio, TX

EXPERIENCE

Graduate Research Assistant, Johns Hopkins University (Econ-ARK)

Baltimore, MD | Sep 2023 – May 2025

- Created written guides and tutorials, hosted on [GitHub](#), to help incoming PhD students learn the computational methods behind Econ-ARK, an open-source research toolkit used by central banks and academic economists worldwide to build and solve models of household financial decision-making.
- Compiled and analyzed 35 years of Federal Reserve internal forecast data (1982–2017), comparing forecast accuracy for unemployment and consumer spending against private-sector benchmarks, in an attempt to demonstrate that the Fed's own forecasts consistently outperformed professional forecasters.
- Co-authored a referee report for a Journal of Political Economy submission studying whether wealthier households form more accurate expectations about labor market conditions; this can be shown to create a feedback loop which amplifies wealth inequality and macroeconomic volatility. The report provided structured feedback on the model's assumptions, empirical fit, and policy implications.

Graduate Teaching Assistant, Johns Hopkins University

Baltimore, MD | Aug 2021 – May 2026

- Led weekly discussion sections and held office hours for introductory and intermediate macroeconomics courses (25–40 students per semester, six semesters across two course levels).
- Designed and graded problem sets and exams covering GDP measurement, inflation, monetary and fiscal policy, and economic growth.
- Served as sole TA for Debates in Macroeconomics, a 16-student upper-level seminar in which students applied micro- and macroeconomic models to live policy debates on climate change, immigration, and inequality; took primary responsibility for grading and held weekly office hours independently.

Economic Research Intern, Federal Reserve Board, Financial Stability Division

Washington, DC | Jun 2021 – Aug 2022

- Worked under direct supervision to reproduce the equilibrium of a peer-reviewed paper on optimal fossil fuel taxation, building toward that goal by solving a series of dynamic macroeconomic models. This included deriving first-order conditions, linearizing around the steady state, and computing equilibrium policy functions and impulse responses using MATLAB and Dynare, which all build upon a standard approach to mathematical and computational models of the macroeconomy.
- Successfully implemented and validated a two-sector dynamic model in Dynare, producing steady-state values, variance decompositions, and business-cycle moments that matched standard benchmarks for the model class.

Post-Baccalaureate Research Scholar, Yale University, Emerging Scholars Initiative

New Haven, CT | Jul 2019 – Jun 2020

- Developed a three-player game theory model analyzing how social media platforms can deter anonymous harassment by adjusting the probability of revealing offending users' real identities.
- Identified CrowdTangle, a social media dataset tracking post-level engagement metrics, as a potential source for empirically testing the model's predictions in future work.
- Presented research findings at the Yale Emerging Scholars annual conference under faculty supervision.

HONORS, FELLOWSHIPS & PRESENTATIONS

Roger Spencer Scholarship for Superior Performance in Economics

Named academic award for outstanding achievement in economics

Trinity University

McNair Scholars Program

Federally-funded research fellowship preparing underrepresented students for doctoral study

Trinity University

Research In Color Foundation Fellow

Competitive program pairing emerging economists of color with senior researchers for mentorship and independent research

Mentor: Dr. Jessica Goldberg, University of Maryland

Presenter, AEA Summer Mentoring Pipeline Conference (SMPC)

2025

Presented job market paper; conference hosted by the AEA Committee on the Status of Minority Groups in the Economics Profession

Presenter, Research In Color Foundation Annual Conference

Research In Color Foundation, Aug 2020

Presented early-stage game theory research on social media deterrence mechanisms

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming & Analysis: Python · MATLAB · Stata · LaTeX · Git/GitHub · Dynare · R